

Chapter 177-6

Liang Shi's Vlogs were also flourishing. She had even found some joy in directing, and in her spare time, she would often exchange insights with Gu Yixue.

Life was gradually becoming interesting and vibrant.

Lu Jiayi and Fu You's wedding was scheduled for late spring, to be held in the Capital¹.

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu even flew to the Capital for it.

The Lu family was considered a prestigious family in the Capital, and the Fu family was not to be underestimated either. It was just that Fu You's status wasn't quite so illustrious.

Fu You's mother was not Madam Fu, and she wasn't even part of the Fu family.

At the wedding, Xu Qingzhu found a spot to sit and bask in the sun while listening to people gossip. They said Fu You's mother had become a nun.

Because back then, Fu You's father had married the current Madam Fu, while Fu You's mother had unknowingly become the other woman.

But others said that Fu You's mother was her father's first love, so Fu You was her father's favorite child, treated much better than the children Madam Fu had given birth to.

However, even Mr. Fu's reach had its limits. He was constantly away on business trips and busy with company matters, so he didn't pay that much attention to Fu You either.

But this wedding was indeed lavishly held.

The best location in the Capital, the most luxurious restaurant, hosting a continuous banquet² with nearly a thousand guests coming and going.

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu even privately discussed which family was richer—the Lu family of the Capital or the Shen family of Haizhou.

In the end, they concluded that the Lu family of the Capital had more power, while the Shen family of Haizhou had more money.

The two of them were just like ordinary wives, casually discussing high-society gossip.

This wedding gave Liang Shi quite a shock, making her start planning something in her heart.

When the time came, their wedding should be held by the sea.

Liang Shi wanted to go to the seaside, to send the festivities off to a more distant place.

Liang Shi had never been to the Capital here before, so she took this opportunity to explore the Capital with Xu Qingzhu.

Since the two of them were from Haizhou, Lu Jiayi and Fu You even came to volunteer as their tour guides the day after the wedding was done.

Liang Shi paid particular attention to observing Lu Jiayi.

She noticed that although Lu Jiayi didn't like Fu You, after marriage she was especially tolerant and caring toward Fu You. This care wasn't the kind you'd give to a girl weaker than yourself, but the thoughtfulness you'd show a wife.

Even when Fu You was being somewhat unreasonable, Lu Jiayi would frown first but then still go along with her.

What showed in her eyes wasn't someone compromising for the sake of family business and inheritance rights—it was simply that she disliked certain things, yet she would still accompany Fu You.

Liang Shi suddenly understood the post-marriage state between her and Xu Qingzhu that was described in the original text.

Because Lu Jiayi was just this kind of person.

No matter who she married, once she decided, even if she had to pretend, she could put on the appearance of a good wife.

And she and Xu Qingzhu were such soulmates—the two of them had many things they liked together and could chat well together. Even without romantic love, they could live quite well.

But with Fu You, it was obvious that Lu Jiayi got angry more frequently.

Fu You often tested the dangerous boundaries, yet she never truly made Lu Jiayi angry.

On the night before Liang Shi and the others left the Capital, Lu Jiayi invited them to drink at a club.

It was one of those high-end, proper clubs.

Fu You didn't come.

She said she was attending a classmate reunion and would come over after it ended.

Lu Jiayi fulfilled her duties as a host quite well, but when chatting, she and Xu Qingzhu still couldn't escape business topics.

Although Lu Jiayi was eighty percent confident she would obtain the Lu family's inheritance rights, she had also made two backup plans for herself.

One was to go to Haizhou and start her own business, leaving the Capital for good.

The other was to expand the family business after obtaining the inheritance rights, which would also require Haizhou.

So she had a lot to say to Xu Qingzhu at the moment, and the business ambitions the two were envisioning were indeed grand.

So grand that if Liang Shi didn't know what kind of people these two were, she would have thought they'd drunk several bottles of erguotou³ before they could brag like this.

Around eleven o'clock, Xu Qingzhu was getting sleepy.

Just as they stood up to leave, Fu You finally showed up late, reeking of alcohol.

As soon as she entered, she looked for Lu Jiayi. After Lu Jiayi steadied her, Fu You asked pitifully and aggrieved: "Am I pretty?"

Lu Jiayi: "..."

Lu Jiayi wasn't good at saying these kinds of things—she was like a completely different person from when she was discussing business ambitions with Xu Qingzhu.

But Fu You straightened her shoulders: "Lu Jiayi, are you going to answer or not?"

Lu Jiayi: "...Let's go home."

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu didn't want to be third wheels anymore, so they said their goodbyes and headed out.

They could hear the argument continuing behind them.

"You won't even compliment my looks? Lu Jiayi, are you blind?"

"Lu Jiayi, do you believe I'll break your legs?"

"Lu Jiayi, carry me."

Later, when Liang Shi was helping Xu Qingzhu into the car, she saw Lu Jiayi emerge from the club carrying the drunk Fu You on her back.

Liang Shi gave her a thumbs up.

Lu Jiayi's expression was a mix of helplessness and amusement.

But when she was carrying Fu You into the car, she was particularly careful and attentive.

A person like that—even without love, you could probably spend a lifetime with her.

Liang Shi suddenly sighed with emotion, "Lu Jiayi really is a good person."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

Gu Yixue really did sign a contract with the platform, and just like that, the S+ rated project was handed over to Gu Yixue.

Meanwhile, the Vlogs Liang Shi posted on Weibo also generated a huge response.

Everyone said her Vlogs were shot like documentaries, and many urged her to switch careers and become a director.

Liang Shi didn't lose herself over it, but she did start having thoughts about transitioning from in front of the camera to behind it.

Being in front of the camera only required thinking about herself, but being behind the scenes required multiple considerations—coordination between actors, from initial casting and team organization to later publicity and distribution—all required considerable effort.

Liang Shi felt that being an actress still suited her better for now.

She also squeezed out time to finish reading the novel "Sharp Edge."

It was somewhat dark, but it was definitely the style Gu Yixue liked. Especially the ending—just imagining it, you could picture that sharp aesthetic.

This kind of shot could probably only be filmed by Gu Yixue.

But "Sharp Edge" always gave Liang Shi a sense of déjà vu, a feeling of oppression, as if someone she knew had been written into the book and persecuted.

When she exchanged thoughts with Gu Yixue, Gu Yixue said this was what made this writer remarkable.

Being able to effortlessly draw people into the story.

That's why it made you feel suffocated.

Reading this work felt like drowning in water. Just when you were about to run out of breath, someone would pull you up. Just when you thought you were saved, they would drown you again.

Over and over.

Every single time.

Carrying a beauty on the verge of suffocation.

Liang Shi also began to admire this author called "Wenchuan."

Gu Yixue said she would try to work on the script with this author, and would also try to invite this author to be an on-set screenwriter. The adaptation would be done while respecting the original work as much as possible.

Afterward, Gu Yixue's conversations with Wenchuan went very smoothly, and even the process of writing the script together was incredibly smooth.

In Gu Yixue's words, she had never written a script this smoothly before.

She even felt that creating together with someone else was much more comfortable than creating alone.

Both were very satisfied with the script.

This was probably the mutual appreciation between creators.

Most importantly, both of them understood the core of that story, so the process of expanding on that core was very smooth.

Footnotes:

¹ Capital (京都, Jīngdū) - In this novel, "Jingdu" refers to the capital city of the fictional world, similar to Beijing in our world. It literally means "Capital City."

² Continuous banquet (流水宴, liúshuǐ yàn) - A style of banquet where food is continuously served and guests come and go in waves rather than sitting down for a single meal together. This is common for very large celebrations like weddings where there are too many guests to accommodate at once.

³ Erguotou (二鍋頭) - A strong Chinese grain alcohol (baijiu) typically around 50-60% ABV. It's known as a working-class drink and is relatively cheap. The joke here is that only someone very drunk would make such grandiose claims—but since these are actually wealthy businesswomen, their ambitions are real.